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Complaint & Grievance Handling

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Complaint & Grievance Handling

Part 1: Introduction, Classification, Institutional Mechanisms, and General Procedure

I. Introduction

Meaning of Complaint and Grievance

- **Complaint:** An expression of dissatisfaction made to an organization, related to its products, services, or the complaints-handling process itself, where a response or resolution is explicitly or implicitly expected. In the administrative context, it also refers to allegations of misconduct, corruption, or harassment against a public servant.
- **Grievance:** A formal or informal claim by a citizen or an employee regarding an injustice, unfair treatment, or denial of a rightful service/benefit. It is broader than a complaint and often relates to systemic issues or service delivery failures.

Importance of Grievance Redressal in Public Administration

- **Accountability and Transparency:** Ensures that public officials remain answerable to the citizens they serve.
- **Feedback Mechanism:** Acts as a vital tool for policy formulation and system improvement by identifying recurrent bottlenecks.
- **Citizen-Centric Administration:** Aligns with the Government of India's mandate of "Minimum Government, Maximum Governance," ensuring that public service delivery is efficient, responsive, and empathetic.

Role of Department of Posts (DoP) in Citizen Service Delivery

The Department of Posts is one of the oldest and most widely distributed public service networks globally. Due to its direct interface with millions of citizens daily across mail, banking, insurance, and retail sectors, a robust grievance redressal mechanism is critical. The DoP is obligated to resolve service deficiencies (like delay/loss of articles, COD payment issues) and handle internal administrative complaints (vigilance, sexual harassment, SC/ST employee grievances) in accordance with DoPT and CVC guidelines.

II. Types of Complaints

Complaints in the Department of Posts are broadly classified into the following categories based on their nature and the competent authority handling them:

1. Public Grievances (Service Deficiencies):

- Relate to core postal operations: delay in delivery, loss of articles, abstraction of contents, non-payment/delay in Money Orders, or pending COD amounts (*Ref: OM 10-32/2013-BD&MD (Vol-II) dated 11-12-2015*).

2. Vigilance Complaints:

- Allegations of corruption, malpractice, misappropriation of public funds, or abuse of official position by postal employees. Handled strictly as per CVC guidelines.

3. Anonymous and Pseudonymous Complaints:

- **Anonymous:** Complaints that do not bear the name or address of the complainant.
- **Pseudonymous:** Complaints bearing a fictitious name or address.
- *Ref: CVC Guidelines OM 39-1/2010-Vig dated 29-03-2016.*

4. Complaints of Sexual Harassment at Workplace:

- Complaints registered under the POSH Act, 2013. These involve the constitution of an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) and utilize platforms like the SHe-Box (*Ref: OM 11013/7/2016-Estt.A-III dated 11-01-2017*).

5. SC/ST Grievance Complaints:

- Service matter complaints raised by SC/ST employees, often escalated through or monitored by the Office of the Commissioner for SC/ST (*Ref: OM 36034/2/83-Estt(SCT) dated 23-02-1983*).

6. High-Level Administrative Complaints:

- Special procedures exist for handling complaints against senior officials, such as Secretaries to the Government of India (*Ref: OM 104/100/2009-AVD.I dated 14-01-2010 & subsequent corrigendums*).

III. Institutional Mechanisms

The Department of Posts utilizes a multi-tiered institutional framework to handle different types of grievances effectively:

1. Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS)

- An online web-enabled system developed by NIC in association with the Directorate of Public Grievances (DPG) and Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG).
- Facilitates citizens to lodge grievances online to any Ministry/Department.
- Grievances pertaining to DoP are routed to the respective Circle/Region/Division through the designated Nodal Officers.

2. India Post Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Portal

- The primary internal IT-enabled platform for registering, tracking, and resolving customer complaints at the Post Office, Division, and Circle levels.
- Governed by specific Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for handling complaints (*Ref: OM 009/5/2023-PG dated 04-09-2023*).

3. Social Media & Call Centre Grievance Handling

- **India Post Call Centre:** A toll-free helpline for citizens to register complaints telephonically.
- **Twitter / Social Media:** The DoP actively monitors its official social media handles for immediate grievance capture.
- **Computerized Customer Care Centres (CCC):** Established at Head Post Offices to log and resolve physical and digital complaints.
- *Note on Closure:* Specific instructions govern the closing of grievances received via these channels, especially concerning the delay or loss of articles (*Ref: OM 14-03/2018-PG dated 25-06-2018*).

4. Designated Officers

- **Public Grievance Officers (PGOs):** Appointed at the Directorate, Circle, and Regional levels to monitor the disposal of grievances.
- **Nodal Officers:** Responsible for coordinating the timely resolution of CPGRAMS and CRM tickets within stipulated timelines.

IV. Procedure for Handling Complaints

The step-by-step administrative procedure for handling general service and public grievances is as follows:

1. Receipt and Registration:

- Complaints received physically at the Post Office are immediately entered into the India Post CRM system.
- Digital complaints (CPGRAMS, Twitter, Email) are auto-routed or manually mapped to the concerned office.
- A unique grievance registration number is generated and communicated to the complainant via SMS/Email.

2. Preliminary Scrutiny:

- The receiving officer checks if the complaint pertains to their jurisdiction. If not, it is seamlessly transferred to the appropriate office within the CRM/CPGRAMS network.
- Frivolous complaints or those lacking basic details (like article number or date of booking) are flagged for clarification.

3. Forwarding to Competent Authority:

- Vigilance complaints are segregated and sent confidentially to the Divisional Head/Vigilance Officer.
- Operational complaints are forwarded to the concerned Postmaster or Mail Overseer for ground verification.

4. Investigation and Verification:

- Original records (e.g., delivery slips, beat books, system tracking logs) are verified.

- In cases of financial loss or fraud, a preliminary enquiry is ordered immediately.

5. Action Taken and Resolution:

- Corrective action is executed (e.g., delivery of the delayed article, payment of the pending COD/Money Order).
- In cases of loss/damage, compensation is sanctioned as per Post Office Guide rules.

6. Communication to Complainant and Closure:

- A reasoned and polite reply is drafted. "One-line" or generic replies (e.g., "Matter resolved") are strictly discouraged.
- The grievance is marked as 'Closed' in the CRM/CPGRAMS system only after the final resolution has been communicated to the customer.

Part 2: Specialized Complaints, Timelines, and Monitoring Mechanisms

V. Handling Anonymous and Pseudonymous Complaints

The handling of anonymous and pseudonymous complaints is a critical area, particularly to protect government servants from frivolous, vindictive, or blackmail-driven allegations.

1. CVC Guidelines and General Principles

- **Strict Prohibition on Action:** As per CVC Guidelines (OM 39-1/2010-Vig dated 29-03-2016), no action is to be taken on anonymous (no name/address) or pseudonymous (fictitious name/address) complaints. They must be filed and kept on record without initiating any preliminary enquiry.

- **Verification of Identity:** If a complaint contains verifiable allegations and a specific name/address, the receiving authority must first issue a registered acknowledgment to the complainant to verify their identity. If the letter returns undelivered or the complainant denies sending it, it is treated as pseudonymous and filed.
- **Protection Against Misuse:** These guidelines are strictly implemented in the Department of Posts to ensure that the morale of Postal Officers (e.g., Postmasters, Divisional Superintendents) is not adversely affected by baseless allegations from disgruntled elements.

2. PIDPI Framework (Whistleblower Protection)

- For genuine informers who wish to hide their identity, the "Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informers" (PIDPI) resolution is used.
- Instructions have been explicitly issued regarding the strict non-disclosure of the identity of the complainant under PIDPI (*Ref: Punjab Circle OM CPT/20-1/2019 dated 26-03-2021*). Such complaints are processed through a designated competent authority while keeping the envelope and identity confidential.

VI. Vigilance Related Complaints

Vigilance complaints involve allegations of a malafide nature, such as bribery, embezzlement of post office cash, or intentional misuse of official position.

1. Distinction Between Service Grievance and Vigilance

- A service grievance (e.g., delay in delivery) is handled administratively. However, if the delay is proven to be intentional to extract a bribe, it converts into a vigilance complaint.
- All vigilance complaints must be routed to the Divisional Head or the Circle Vigilance Officer depending on the rank of the accused official.

2. Reference to CVC

- Specific clarifications exist regarding making references to the Central Vigilance Commission for advice on complaints and second-stage advice cases (*Ref: CVC Guidelines OM 003/VGL/056 dated 28-01-2010*).
- The CVC advises on the quantum of penalty or whether to initiate major/minor penalty proceedings based on the preliminary enquiry report.

3. Complaints Against High-Ranking Officials

- There is a distinct procedure for handling complaints against Secretaries to the Government of India (*Ref: OM 104/100/2009-AVD.I dated 14-01-2010, Corrigendum dated 27-02-2020 & 06-05-2011*).
- Such complaints undergo a specialized scrutiny mechanism by a designated Group of Ministers or a high-level committee before any formal enquiry is sanctioned.

VII. Complaints Relating to Sexual Harassment

The Department of Posts maintains a zero-tolerance policy towards sexual harassment at the workplace, strictly adhering to the POSH Act, 2013 and DoPT guidelines.

1. Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) Framework

- **Constitution:** Every postal division and administrative office must constitute an ICC. Special instructions exist for constituting a Complaints Committee to enquire into complaints made against officers of the level of Secretary and Additional Secretary (*Ref: OM 11013/3/2009-Estt.(A) dated 02-02-2009*).
- **Seniority of Chairperson:** The Chairperson of the Complaint Committee must be a senior female employee. Clarifications have been issued regarding the seniority

of the Chairperson to ensure fair and uninfluenced proceedings (*Ref: OM 11013/2/2014-Estt.A-III dated 07-11-2016*).

2. Reporting and Follow-up Action

- The mechanism relating to sexual harassment dictates that the ICC's report is treated as a preliminary enquiry report for disciplinary proceedings (*Ref: OM 11013/3/2009-Estt.(A) dated 08-10-2009*).
- Strict follow-up action must be taken on the reports of the Complaints Committee (*Ref: OM 11013/11/2001-Estt.(A) dated 12-12-2002 & 04-08-2005*).

3. SHe-Box Platform

- Female employees can register their grievances through the "SHe-Box" (Sexual Harassment electronic-Box), an online complaint management system that routes the complaint directly to the concerned Ministry/Department's ICC (*Ref: OM 11013/7/2016-Estt.A-III dated 11-01-2017*).

VIII. Complaints from SC/ST Employees

Grievances from Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) employees regarding service matters (promotions, transfers, discriminatory treatment) are monitored with high priority.

1. Role of the Commissioner for SC/ST

- Action must be taken by Ministries/Departments on complaints in service matters from SC/ST employees routed through the Office of the Commissioner for SC/ST (*Ref: OM 36034/2/83-Estt(SCT) dated 23-02-1983*).
- Follow-up action is required on special studies and complaints received by the Commissioner (*Ref: OM 36024/1/78-Estt.(SCT) dated 27-06-1978 & 20-02-1979*).

2. Enquiry and Record Calling

- Guidelines clarify whether the Commissioner for SC/ST can call for original records and files in specific cases where complaints have been made, and whether SC/ST government servants can write to him directly (*Ref: OM 17016/1/76-SCT(C) dated 08-04-1976 and OM 8/2/69-(SCT)(1) dated 01-10-1974*).
- Departments are mandated to provide necessary assistance in the investigation of these complaints (*Ref: OM 16/8/68-Estt dated 24-04-1970*).

IX. Timeline for Disposal of Grievances

Timely disposal of grievances is a key metric for evaluating the efficiency of a Post Office or Postal Division.

1. CRM and CPGRAMS Timelines

- **Reduction of Timelines:** To enhance citizen satisfaction, the stipulated timeline for the disposal of grievances on the Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Platform has been progressively reduced (*Ref: OM PG-01/3/2021-PG-DoP dated 18-08-2022*).
- While standard CPGRAMS guidelines historically provided a 30-day window, internal DoP CRM targets often mandate resolution within 7 to 15 days depending on the nature of the complaint (e.g., financial fraud vs. ordinary mail delay).

2. SOP for Complaint Handling

- The Department has issued a comprehensive Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for complaint handling on CRM to standardize response times across all Circles (*Ref: OM 009/5/2023-PG dated 04-09-2023*).

X. Monitoring and Review Mechanisms

A robust grievance system relies heavily on continuous monitoring to prevent pendency.

1. Dashboard Monitoring

- The Directorate and Circle Offices utilize dynamic digital dashboards to monitor the pendency of public grievances.
- Red-flagging occurs when a grievance breaches the stipulated timeline.

2. Accountability and Review

- General guidelines dictate that public grievance handling (*Ref: OM PG-29/1/2022-PG-DoP dated 28-07-2022*) must be reviewed in monthly coordination meetings by the Head of the Circle (Chief Postmaster General) or the Divisional Superintendent.
- Persistent delays in resolving complaints by specific Post Offices can lead to administrative action against the responsible supervisory staff.

Part 3: Closure, Practical Implementation, and Examination Perspective

XI. Closure of Complaints

The closure of a grievance is as crucial as its registration. Improper closure leads to appeals and dissatisfaction, defeating the purpose of the grievance redressal mechanism.

1. Conditions for Closure

- A complaint can only be closed when a final, substantive resolution has been provided to the complainant.

- Interim replies (e.g., "The matter is under investigation") do not constitute grounds for closing a ticket in CRM or CPGRAMS.
- Specific instructions exist regarding the *Closing of grievances received in India Post Call Centre, Twitter and CCC - cases pertaining to delay/loss of the articles* (Ref: OM 14-03/2018-PG dated 25-06-2018). These cases require mandatory verification of the final delivery status or sanction of compensation before closure.

2. Documentation and Communication

- All closures must be backed by documentary evidence (e.g., delivery slip signature, payment voucher for COD/Money Order).
- The final reply must be communicated to the customer in clear, polite language, detailing the findings and the action taken.
- *Pending COD amounts:* Grievances regarding non-payment of COD must be closed only after the physical crediting of the amount to the sender's account (Ref: OM 10-32/2013-BD&MD (Vol-II) dated 11-12-2015).

XII. Responsibilities of Postal Officers

Grievance handling is a decentralized, multi-level responsibility within the Department of Posts.

1. Postmaster (Head Post Office / Sub Post Office)

- **First Point of Contact:** Responsible for immediate logging of physical/oral complaints into the CRM.
- **Fact-Finding:** Conducting initial inquiries regarding delayed mail, missing articles, or misbehavior by counter staff.
- **Customer Interaction:** Engaging directly with aggrieved customers to de-escalate issues and provide factual updates.

2. Divisional Superintendent (SPs/SSPs)

- **Nodal Officer:** Acts as the primary nodal authority for all CRM and CPGRAMS tickets pertaining to their division.
- **Vigilance & Disciplinary Action:** Initiates preliminary inquiries into vigilance complaints and takes disciplinary action (minor/major penalties) if service deficiencies are found to be intentional or due to gross negligence.
- **Monitoring:** Conducts weekly reviews of pending grievances to ensure zero pendency beyond the stipulated timeline.

3. Circle Office (CPMG / DPS)

- **Appellate Authority:** Reviews appeals against closed grievances if the citizen is dissatisfied.
- **Systemic Corrections:** Analyzes grievance data to identify systemic failures (e.g., chronic mail delays on a specific route) and implements structural solutions.

4. Postal Directorate

- **Policy Formulation:** Issues guidelines, SOPs, and sets timelines (e.g., OM 009/5/2023-PG on CRM SOP).
- **Inter-Ministerial Coordination:** Liaises with DARPG, CVC, and other nodal ministries on macro-level public grievance strategies.

XIII. Important Government Orders (Chronological Summary)

Below is an exhaustive compilation of key orders concerning complaint and grievance handling, mapped from DoPT, CVC, and DoP records:

Year	Authority	Order / OM Number	Subject / Key Provision
1970	DoPT/Estt	16/8/68-Estt (24-04-1970)	Assistance by Ministries in investigation of complaints by Commissioner for SC/ST.
1974	DoPT/Estt	8/2/69-(SCT)(1) (01-10-1974)	Commissioner for SC/ST calling for original records for complaints.
1983	DoPT/Estt	36034/2/83-Estt(SCT) (23-02-1983)	Action taken by Ministries on complaints from SC/ST employees.
2009	DoPT/Estt	11013/3/2009-Estt.(A) (02-02-2009)	Constitution of Complaints Committee for sexual harassment against Secretary-level officers.
2010	DoPT/AVD	104/100/2009-AVD.I (14-01-2010)	Procedure for handling complaints against Secretaries to Govt of India.
2010	CVC	003/VGL/056 (28-01-2010)	Clarification on referring to CVC for advice on complaints/second-stage advice.
2013	DoPT/AVD	104/76/2011-AVD.I (18-10-2013)	General guidelines regarding handling of complaints in Ministries/Departments.
2015	DoP/Mails	10-32/2013-BD&MD (11-12-2015)	Resolution of pending complaints and payments of COD amount to customers.
2016	CVC	39-1/2010-Vig (29-03-2016)	Strict Action: No action to be taken on Anonymous/Pseudonymous Complaints.
2016	DoPT/Estt	11013/2/2014-Estt.A-III (09-09-2016)	Prevention of Sexual Harassment - Seniority of the Chairperson of ICC.

2017	DoPT/Estt	11013/7/2016-Estt.A-III (11-01-2017)	Launch of Online complaint management system titled SHe-Box .
2018	DoP/PG	14-03/2018-PG (25-06-2018)	Proper closing of grievances received via Call Centre, Twitter, and CCC (loss/delay).
2021	DoP/Circle	CPT/20-1/2019 (26-03-2021)	Instructions for non-disclosure of complainant identity under PIDPI (Whistleblower).
2022	DoP/PG	PG-01/3/2021-PG-DoP (18-08-2022)	Timeline Reduction: Decreasing stipulated timelines for disposal on CRM Platform.
2023	DoP/PG	009/5/2023-PG (04-09-2023)	Issuance of comprehensive SOP for complaint handling on India Post CRM.

XIV. Practical Implementation in Post Offices

For operational staff, theoretical knowledge must translate into practical efficiency:

1. **Immediate Acknowledgment:** Whether a customer complains on Twitter or at the counter, immediate acknowledgment defuses tension.
2. **Root Cause Analysis (RCA):** Instead of just delivering a delayed parcel, the Postmaster must investigate *why* it was delayed (e.g., missent by RMS, kept pending by postman) and correct the specific node.
3. **Proper Use of CRM Remarks:** Staff must enter detailed, date-wise remarks in the CRM. "Matter resolved" is insufficient; "Article delivered on DD/MM/YYYY vide beat no. X, customer satisfied" is the correct standard.
4. **Awareness of Committees:** Displaying the names and contact details of the Internal Complaints Committee (POSH) members prominently in the Post Office is a mandatory preventive action.

XV. Examination Perspective (LDCE / Postal Exams)

For candidates preparing for Postal Service Group 'B' (PS Gr. B) exam, the following concepts are highly probable:

- **Anonymous/Pseudonymous Rule:** Frequently asked. *Rule:* No action to be taken; file it. Governed by CVC circular dated 29-03-2016.
- **PIDPI:** Understand the expansion (*Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informers*) and its core mandate: absolute protection of the complainant's identity.
- **POSH ICC Constitution:** Remember that the Chairperson *must* be a senior female employee (OM dated 09-09-2016).
- **SHe-Box:** Identify this as the specific DoPT portal for registering sexual harassment complaints.
- **CRM vs. CPGRAMS:** CPGRAMS is the overarching Govt of India portal (DARPG), while CRM is the internal DoP system. Know the recent timeline reductions (OM dated 18-08-2022).
- **SC/ST Grievances:** Be aware that the Commissioner for SC/ST has powers to call for original records in specific complaint scenarios (OM dated 01-10-1974).

Detailed, Exam-Oriented Notes for each of the Office Memorandums (OMs) and circulars listed in Sections XIII and XV. These Notes break down the core administrative principles, procedural mandates, and examination significance of each order.

1. OMs Related to Grievances of SC/ST Employees

A. OM No. 16/8/68-Estt dated 24-04-1970

- **Authority:** DoPT (Establishment)
- **Subject:** Assistance by Ministries in the investigation of complaints received by the Commissioner for SC/ST.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Mandates that all Ministries/Departments must extend full cooperation to the Commissioner for SC/ST when they are investigating service-level grievances or complaints of discrimination.
 - Departments are required to appoint a liaison officer to supply necessary facts, figures, and clarification promptly to the Commissioner's office.

B. OM No. 8/2/69-(SCT)(1) dated 01-10-1974

- **Authority:** DoPT (Establishment)
- **Subject:** Question whether the Commissioner for SC/ST can call for original records and files in specific cases.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Clarifies the statutory powers of the Commissioner. It establishes that the Commissioner *can* call for original files and records from any

Ministry/Department to investigate complaints of non-implementation of reservation policies or harassment.

- It also clarifies that SC/ST government servants have the right to write directly to the Commissioner detailing their grievances, bypassing the normal proper channel if they feel their complaints are being suppressed locally.
- **Exam Significance:** Highly relevant for questions regarding the powers of the SC/ST Commissioner and the rights of SC/ST employees to bypass standard routing for grievances.

C. OM No. 36034/2/83-Estt(SCT) dated 23-02-1983

- **Authority:** DoPT (Establishment)
- **Subject:** Action taken by various Ministries on complaints from SC/ST employees through the Office of the Commissioner.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Lays down the timeline and accountability matrix for responding to the Commissioner.
 - Departments cannot merely file away the Commissioner's references; they must provide an Action Taken Report (ATR) detailing what remedial measures were implemented to resolve the genuine grievances of the SC/ST employee.

2. OMs Related to General and Vigilance Complaints

D. OM No. 104/100/2009-AVD.I dated 14-01-2010 (and subsequent corrigendums)

- **Authority:** DoPT (Administrative Vigilance Division)

- **Subject:** Procedure for handling complaints against Secretaries to the Government of India.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - To protect top-level executives from frivolous and vindictive complaints that could paralyze decision-making, this OM dictates a special mechanism.
 - Complaints against Secretaries are not handled by standard disciplinary authorities. They are scrutinized by a specialized Group of Ministers or a high-level apex committee.
 - No preliminary enquiry or agency investigation (like CBI) can be initiated without the approval of this high-level authority.

E. CVC Circular No. 003/VGL/056 dated 28-01-2010

- **Authority:** Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)
- **Subject:** Clarification regarding making a reference to the Commission for advice on complaints and second-stage advice.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Defines when a Ministry/Department must approach the CVC.
 - **First Stage Advice:** Sought after a preliminary enquiry report is ready, to decide whether to drop the charges or initiate minor/major penalty proceedings.
 - **Second Stage Advice:** Sought after the formal inquiry is completed but before the Disciplinary Authority imposes the final penalty. This ensures the penalty is commensurate with the proven misconduct.

F. OM No. 104/76/2011-AVD.I dated 18-10-2013 (and 31-03-2015)

- **Authority:** DoPT (AVD)
- **Subject:** Guidelines regarding the handling of complaints in Ministries/Departments.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Acts as the master circular for handling general administrative and vigilance complaints.
 - Re-emphasizes that complaints must contain specific, verifiable details. Vague allegations (e.g., "the postmaster is corrupt") without dates, amounts, or incident details should not trigger an investigation.

G. CVC Circular No. 39-1/2010-Vig dated 29-03-2016

- **Authority:** CVC
- **Subject:** Action on Anonymous/Pseudonymous Complaints.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - **Absolute Prohibition:** Clearly instructs that *no action whatsoever* is to be taken on anonymous (no name/address) or pseudonymous (fake name/address) complaints.
 - Such complaints must be simply filed.
 - If a complaint has a name, a registered acknowledgment must be sent. If it returns undelivered or is denied by the signatory, it is deemed pseudonymous and filed.
- **Exam Significance:** This is a definitive rule frequently tested in LDCE/IP exams to check if the candidate understands the protection granted to public servants against malicious complaints.

H. Punjab Circle OM CPT/20-1/2019 dated 26-03-2021 (PIDPI)

- **Authority:** Department of Posts (Example of Circle-level implementation)
 - **Subject:** Instructions for non-disclosure of complainant identity under PIDPI.
 - **Key Provisions:**
 - PIDPI stands for **Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informers**.
 - If a complaint is marked "PIDPI", the envelope is opened only by a designated nodal officer.
 - The identity of the whistleblower is concealed, and the complaint is processed using a pseudonym or reference number to protect the employee/citizen from harassment or retaliation.
 - **Exam Significance:** Candidates must know the expansion of PIDPI and its core function (identity protection of the whistleblower).
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3. OM's Related to Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

I. OM No. 11013/3/2009-Estt.(A) dated 02-02-2009 & 08-10-2009

- **Authority:** DoPT (Establishment)
 - **Subject:** Complaints Committee mechanism relating to sexual harassment / against Secretary-level officers.
 - **Key Provisions:**
 - Formalizes the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) as the mandatory inquiring authority for sexual harassment cases.
-

- The report of the ICC is to be treated directly as a preliminary enquiry report, allowing the Disciplinary Authority to frame charges without needing a separate parallel investigation.

J. OM No. 11013/2/2014-Estt.A-III dated 09-09-2016 & 07-11-2016

- **Authority:** DoPT (Establishment)
- **Subject:** Seniority of the Chairperson of the Complaint Committee.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Mandates that the Chairperson of the ICC must be a **senior female employee**.
 - Clarifies that if a female officer of sufficient seniority is not available in the same office, she can be nominated from another office or administrative unit to ensure the Chairperson is not junior to the accused, preventing undue influence.
- **Exam Significance:** Crucial for questions on the composition of the ICC.

K. OM No. 11013/7/2016-Estt.A-III dated 11-01-2017

- **Authority:** DoPT (Establishment)
- **Subject:** Online complaint management system titled SHe-Box.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Introduces the **Sexual Harassment electronic-Box (SHe-Box)**.
 - It allows female employees (and women interacting with the government office) to file complaints online directly to the Ministry of Women and Child Development, which then routes it to the concerned Department's ICC.

- **Exam Significance:** Direct question potential on identifying the portal used for POSH complaints.

4. OMs Related to Core Postal Services and CRM Handling

L. OM No. 10-32/2013-BD&MD (Vol-II) dated 11-12-2015

- **Authority:** Department of Posts (Business Development & Mails Directorate)
- **Subject:** Pending complaints and payments of pending COD amount to customers.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Addresses a major e-commerce grievance: delay in remitting Cash on Delivery (COD) amounts to billers/senders after the article is delivered.
 - Mandates that no CRM grievance regarding COD can be closed until the specific financial transaction (crediting the biller's account) is successfully completed and verified.

M. OM No. 14-03/2018-PG dated 25-06-2018

- **Authority:** Department of Posts (Public Grievance Division)
- **Subject:** Closing of grievances received via Call Centre, Twitter, and CCC (loss/delay).
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Prohibits arbitrary closing of tickets.
 - If an article is lost or irreparably delayed, the ticket can only be closed after the compensation has been sanctioned and paid to the customer, or a final, reasoned regret letter with factual findings is issued.

N. OM No. PG-01/3/2021-PG-DoP dated 18-08-2022

- **Authority:** Department of Posts (PG Division)
- **Subject:** Reduction of stipulated timeline for disposal of grievances on CRM Platform.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - Shifts the focus from the traditional 30-day resolution window to much tighter timelines (e.g., 7 to 15 days depending on the category) to align with modern e-commerce and banking standards.
 - Implements an auto-escalation matrix if the first-level resolution breaches the new shortened timelines.

O. OM No. 009/5/2023-PG dated 04-09-2023

- **Authority:** Department of Posts (PG Division)
- **Subject:** Issuance of SOP for complaint handling on CRM.
- **Key Provisions:**
 - The most recent and comprehensive operational guide for Postmasters and Nodal Officers.
 - Dictates the exact workflow: Acknowledgment → Root Cause Analysis → Rectification → Polite Drafting of Final Reply → Closure.
 - Explicitly bans "one-line replies" (e.g., "Closed," "Delivered," "Sorted") and requires descriptive resolutions outlining the action taken.